

Soufiane Essahli

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ACADEMIC EDUCATION

Mohammed VI Polytechnic University (UM6P) <i>Ph.D. in AI & Cybersecurity</i>	Rabat, Morocco Sep 2025 – Present
The Euro-Mediterranean University <i>Cybersecurity Engineering, Minor in Computer Engineering</i>	Fes, Morocco Sep 2020 – Jun 2025
The Euro-Mediterranean University <i>Preparatory Classes; two years with an honorable ranking.</i>	Fes, Morocco Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Confidential Client <i>Cybersecurity Consultant</i>	Rabat, Morocco Oct 2025 – Mar 2026, Part-time
- Conducted a comprehensive audit of the organization's cybersecurity posture, covering network infrastructure, access controls, and application security. - Delivered actionable remediation plans and advised on security best practices aligned with industry standards (OWASP, CIS, NIST). - Assisted in hardening internal systems.	
Mohammed VI Polytechnic University (UM6P) <i>AI & Data Science Intern, Misinformation Detection</i>	Benguerir, Morocco Feb 2025 – Aug 2025, Full-time
- Developed an end-to-end misinformation detection pipeline tailored to the Moroccan context, leveraging BERT-based models adapted for Arabic and Darija low-resource dialects. - Designed a monitoring dashboard tracking misinformation propagation and source virality; deployed the full system on HPC infrastructure.	
Marsa Maroc <i>IT Security Intern</i>	Casablanca, Morocco June 2023 – August 2023, Full-time
- Conducted security audits and penetration tests (black-box & white-box) using Kali Linux, Burp Suite, and Nessus, following OWASP and CIS standards. - Documented vulnerabilities with CVSS scoring and assisted in remediation of identified weaknesses.	

PUBLICATIONS

FakeZero: Real-Time, Privacy-Preserving Misinformation Detection for Facebook and X <i>IEEE Conference Publication — IEEE Xplore, 2025</i>	<i>B-Ranked Conference</i>
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SKILLS

Programming: Python, C++, Bash/Shell, JavaScript, SQL
AI & Machine Learning: PyTorch, HuggingFace, BERT-based models, LLMs, RAG, fine-tuning, quantization, adversarial ML, privacy-preserving inference
Cybersecurity: Penetration Testing (black/white-box), Reverse Engineering, Cryptography, Web & Network Security, OWASP, MITRE ATT&CK, CVSS, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, Kali Linux
Infrastructure & DevOps: Docker, Linux, Git, CI/CD, HPC, REST APIs

ACHIEVEMENTS

DGSSI Competition: Ranked 3rd among all Moroccan universities — awarded \$2,000
1337 CyberOdyssey CTF: Ranked 1st nationally — awarded \$3,200
CSAW CTF Finalist (2024 & 2025): Two-time MENA finalist (finals in Abu Dhabi, UAE); ranked 7th in 2024 and 4th in 2025.
Moroccan Cybersecurity Camp 11th Edition: Ranked 2nd at the ENSIAS National CTF — awarded \$1,500

EXTRACURRICULAR

Member of 0xNox CTF team: Known as **HostileNinja72**, competing in Cryptography, Reverse Engineering, and Web Challenges. **Ranked 1st in Morocco**, with a strong national and international competitive record.

President of UEMF Astronomy Club: Organized weekly lectures and events fostering critical thinking and community engagement around astronomy and science.